

MATTHEW O'LEARY

Production Designer | Print, Packaging & Editorial Collateral
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Hands-on Production Designer with 20+ years of experience producing accurate, press-ready packaging, editorial publications, books, retail catalogs, labels, and branded collateral. Advanced user of Adobe InDesign, Illustrator, Photoshop, and Acrobat Pro, with deep experience in complex layout production, packaging mechanicals, dielines, prepress, color management, proofing, and vendor-ready delivery.

Known for detail-oriented execution in deadline-driven environments: translating approved creative into clean final files, managing revisions, maintaining consistent standards across large systems and multiple SKUs, and collaborating effectively with designers, editors, vendors, and cross-functional teams. Intentionally focused on hands-on production work where accuracy, organization, and quality control are essential.

CORE SKILLS

- Production Design & Mechanical Files: Print-ready production files, complex InDesign page composition, Illustrator production artwork, layout corrections, formatting, production mechanicals, final file proofing, preflight, PDF/X workflows, file packaging, naming conventions, and version control
- Packaging & Product Collateral: CPG packaging, labels, rigid and flexible dielines, multi-panel packaging layouts, color separations, CMYK and spot/Pantone color, FDA-compliant copy placement, multi-SKU retail rollouts, branded collateral
- Editorial & Publication Production: Magazine and custom-publication design, book interiors and covers, retail catalogs, typography, page systems, master pages, image placement, page mapping, pagination, imposition, and proof cycles
- Adobe Creative Suite: Adobe InDesign, Illustrator, Photoshop, and Acrobat Pro; advanced layout, file-building, prepress, image handling, and print-production workflows
- Workflow & Collaboration: Production schedules, revision tracking, stakeholder approvals, vendor and printer coordination, asset organization, reusable templates, Airtable, Trello, digital asset management, and remote collaboration
- Efficiency Tools: AI-assisted writing, proofing, and workflow automation for repetitive production tasks, with final human review and print-spec verification
- Platforms: macOS-based Adobe Creative Cloud workflow; proficient with current Apple desktop and mobile platforms

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

California Magazine (Cal Alumni Association) – Designer & Production Manager

Remote (Contract) | Aug 2026 – Present

- Lead hands-on layout, image placement, and production-file preparation for *California* magazine, maintaining visual and typographic consistency across editorial pages, advertising, and custom inserts using InDesign, Photoshop, and Illustrator.
- Prepare and route layouts and proofs through Design Director and editorial approval cycles; manage detailed revisions under publication deadlines.
- Coordinate with print vendor Quad from press-ready file delivery through proof approval, ensuring final files meet production specifications.
- Produce supporting digital assets after print delivery, using efficient template-based and AI-assisted workflows where appropriate.

Matt O’Leary Design – Freelance Graphic Designer & Production Consultant

Santa Cruz, CA | 2010 – Present

- Independently design and prepare press-ready and digital assets from creative brief through final production delivery for packaging, publishing, and branded-collateral clients.
- Build FDA-compliant packaging mechanicals, product-label layouts, and production files aligned with manufacturing requirements, dielines, and brand standards.
- Coordinate with print and fabrication vendors on material specifications, proofs, quality control, revisions, and final delivery.
- Maintain organized project files, production checklists, timelines, and client approvals using Trello and Adobe Creative Suite workflows.

OBXtek – Production Support Specialist

Monterey, CA | Dec 2024 – Oct 2025

- Produced layouts, curriculum graphics, and media assets for Defense Language Institute learning modules using InDesign, Photoshop, and Illustrator.
- Standardized visual assets and templates for consistency across 14+ language pipelines; coordinated deliverables, version updates, and deadlines in Airtable.
- Supported accurate, repeatable production workflows across a large, cross-functional educational-content environment.

Wiser Solutions – Senior Designer

Remote | Apr 2022 – Mar 2023

- Managed production assets and template-based design-system consistency across a suite of digital applications.
- Collaborated with remote teams to standardize asset handoffs, maintain brand guidelines, and reduce file errors.

Axway – Senior Designer

Remote | Mar 2018 – Apr 2022

- Designed and production-built branded layouts for global web properties and physical and digital marketing campaigns.
- Developed template-driven systems that improved consistency and accelerated asset delivery across distributed teams.

Kiteworks – Product Designer

Palo Alto, CA | Aug 2014 – Feb 2018

- Delivered organized, production-ready visual assets for an enterprise platform in close collaboration with engineering.
- Maintained design-system standards for typographic consistency, reusable assets, and reliable implementation.

FastPencil – Creative Lead

Campbell, CA | Oct 2011 – May 2014

- Led typographic systems and production design for 50+ book interiors and covers annually using InDesign and Illustrator.
- Prepared final files for commercial printers and self-publishing platforms, including KDP and IngramSpark, supporting a high rate of first-pass file acceptance.
- Managed layout consistency, proof corrections, image placement, and final delivery across concurrent publishing projects.

McDill Associates – Print Production Manager

Soquel, CA | Sep 2008 – Nov 2011

- Designed packaging and managed print-production workflows for national retail brands, including Costco, Martinelli's, and Rainbow Light.
- Built and verified packaging dielines, prepared spot-color separations, placed regulated packaging copy, and coordinated with printers and paper suppliers.
- Supported accurate, on-time multi-SKU retail rollouts through file QA, production coordination, and vendor communication.

West Marine – Prepress Manager

Watsonville, CA | Jan 2002 – Aug 2008

- Designed, built, and optimized press-ready files for 800+ page national retail catalogs.
- Managed prepress workflows including preflight, color management, pagination, imposition, proofing, and high-volume seasonal delivery.
- Coordinated with print vendors to maintain schedule, quality, and production specifications across major retail catalog programs.

EDUCATION

University of California, Santa Cruz

Coursework in Art, Design & Visual Studies